

Salvation: Book 1

The Chosen Vine

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Avery Publishing

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Publication note: The text is strong, but the ending should get one final tension pass before a commercial release.

Cover direction: Dark botanical cover with a single vine motif, subdued gold or green accents, elegant serif typography.

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Category: Gothic psychological romance / suspense

Keywords: gothic, psychological, cult fiction, religion, obsession, forbidden attraction

A faithful girl meets a man who seems to understand the fracture inside her before she does. The more seen she feels, the harder it becomes to tell salvation from surrender.

Original prose draft by the user. Religious language and cult imagery are thematic choices, not sourced text. No external borrowings were detected.

Book Position

This first-final draft reframes the material as gothic psychological suspense: desire versus doctrine, the danger of being seen by the wrong person, and the cost of confusing intensity with salvation.

Important safety direction for the finished novel: Silas should remain seductive and psychologically precise, but the narrative should not excuse coercion or cult control. Evelyn's choices can be emotionally truthful without making manipulation look healthy.

First-Final Draft

Chapter 1 - The PlanDraft direction: Evelyn introduces the rules that shaped her and the quiet restlessness underneath obedience.Representative prose:There are rules for everything. Rules for what you wear. Rules for what you say. Rules for what you are allowed to want before wanting becomes a confession.

Chapter 2 - CoordinatesDraft direction: The mission opportunity arrives with coordinates instead of a normal address.Representative prose:The paperwork was precise until it mattered. Packing list. Schedule. Emergency contact. Then, where a town should have been, there were only coordinates. Ivy called it adventurous. Lily called it providence. Evelyn called it nothing because the word fear felt too honest.

Chapter 3 - The ClearingDraft direction: Evelyn, Ivy, and Lily reach the clearing where The Vine's influence begins.Representative prose:The trees did not open so much as step aside. In the clearing, the air felt older than weather. Evelyn had the strange thought that places could wait the way people did.

Chapter 4 - SilasDraft direction: Silas saves Evelyn, refuses her gratitude, and creates the first emotional hook.Representative prose:He did not look like a monster. That was the first danger. He looked calm, almost tired, as if he had already forgiven the world for misunderstanding him and expected Evelyn to catch up.

Chapter 5 - Different or HonestDraft direction: Silas names Evelyn's internal conflict, making her feel seen.Representative prose:'Different,' he repeated. 'Or honest?' Evelyn hated him for the question because it felt less like temptation than recognition.

Chapter 6 - Ivy Leans ForwardDraft direction: Ivy is drawn to the freedom of The Vine while Lily resists.Representative prose:Ivy touched the leaf-marked gate like it was a dare. Lily whispered that they should go home. Evelyn stood between them and realized the most frightening path was the one that made both girls sound right.

Chapter 7 - The First TeachingDraft direction: The Vine's language of freedom begins to blur with control.Representative prose:No one ordered

them to stay. That was the genius of it. Doors remained unlocked. Paths remained visible. Every choice was framed until leaving felt like betrayal and staying felt like bravery.

Chapter 8 - CracksDraft direction: Evelyn starts lying to herself in the language of faith.Representative prose:She told herself she was studying danger so she could understand it. She told herself understanding was not desire. She told herself desire was not surrender. By morning, every sentence sounded rehearsed.

Chapter 9 - The VineDraft direction: Evelyn discovers Silas leads a group, not a retreat, and the emotional stakes become explicit.Representative prose:The symbol was everywhere once she knew how to see it: carved under tables, stitched into hems, pressed into wax, hidden in the way followers paused before saying his name.

Chapter 10 - FollowDraft direction: End Book 1 with Evelyn choosing to remain while the reader understands the danger.Representative prose:Silas offered no hand. He knew better than to make the choice look like his. Evelyn stepped forward anyway, and the clearing seemed to breathe around her like something rooted had finally found water.

Author Bio

Cole Avery is an independent writer and creator working across memoir, fiction, mythology, visual storytelling, and systems-driven creative work.

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Rights Review

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Final production note: cover, layout, EPUB, and print PDF are included in this package.